

SOME WORDS ARE TOO HEAVY TO SAY.
SO THEY REMAINED HERE.

LETTERS I NEVER SENT

A Collection of Things Never Said

for the things i never had the courage to say

by

Sky 하늘



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Letters I Never Sent

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First Edition

Malaysia

A Gentle Note

This book explores themes of loneliness, grief, depression, healing, and relationships through fictional letters and personal reflection.

While these pages may echo emotions that feel familiar, they are not intended to replace professional mental health care, medical advice, or crisis support.

If any part of this book feels close to your own experience, I hope it reminds you that asking for help is an act of courage, not weakness.

Thank you for allowing these letters to walk beside you.

Be gentle with yourself.

For You

For the quiet hearts

For those who carried conversations

they never had.

For those who kept smiling

while learning how to survive.

I hope these letters

remind you

that you were never alone.

Before You Begin

These letters were never written for one person.

Some may remind you of someone you've lost.

Some may remind you of someone you've become.

Others may remind you of a version of yourself you
thought you'd forgotten.

You don't have to read them in one sitting.

Stay with the letters that stay with you.

Pause when a page feels heavy.

Return when you're ready.

There are no right answers hidden between these pages.

Only moments.

If, somewhere along this journey, you find a little more
kindness for yourself...

Then these letters have already found their purpose.

Welcome.

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LETTER ONE

To the Version of Me That Smiled Too Much

*"Some people become so good at pretending they're okay that even they forget
what they're hiding."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER ONE

To the Version of Me That Smiled Too Much

*"Some people become so good at pretending they're okay that even they
forget what they're hiding."*

Dear You,

I don't know your name.

Maybe that's what makes this easier.

If I knew who you were, I'd probably spend too much time wondering whether these words fit your life. Whether you've been through enough to deserve them. Whether I'm saying the right thing.

But I don't.

So I'll write as if we're sitting across from each other in complete silence.

No introductions.

No expectations.

Just two people carrying things they don't know how to put down.

There was a time when I believed people could always tell when someone was hurting.

I thought sadness had a certain look.

Red eyes.

A quiet voice.

An empty smile.

Then I met people who laughed the loudest in the room.

People who never missed a birthday.

People who checked on everyone else.

People who always said, *"I'm good."*

And somehow, they were the ones falling apart when nobody was looking.

Maybe you've met someone like that.

Maybe...

Maybe you've been that person.

It's strange how we learn to hide.

Not because anyone teaches us to.

But because one day we say, "I'm tired," and someone replies,
"Everyone is."

We say, "I'm struggling," and they remind us someone else has it
worse.

So eventually, we stop speaking.

Not because the pain disappears.

Because we become fluent in silence.

There are days when nothing terrible happens, yet everything
feels heavy.

You wake up.

You brush your teeth.

You answer messages.

You laugh at the right moments.

You finish what you're supposed to do.

From the outside, you've had a perfectly ordinary day.

Inside, it feels like you've been carrying a mountain in your chest.

No one notices.

Not because they don't care.

Because you've become too convincing.

I wonder how many people are reading this while pretending they're only here out of curiosity.

Maybe you told yourself this is just another book.

Just another page.

Just something to pass the time.

But if your eyes stopped here for a reason...

Maybe you're more tired than you admit.

Not the kind of tired that sleep can fix.

The kind that follows you into crowded rooms.

The kind that makes every conversation feel rehearsed.

The kind that whispers, *"Don't tell anyone. You'll only become a burden."*

If you've ever believed that voice

I know how persuasive it can sound.

Pain has a way of making lies feel reasonable.

It tells us we're alone.

It tells us nobody would understand.

It tells us to wait until tomorrow.

Then tomorrow becomes next week.

Next month.

Next year.

Until we forget what it felt like to speak honestly.

Maybe that's why I'm writing this.

Not because I have answers.

I don't.

I'm still learning that strength isn't measured by how much we can carry in silence.

Sometimes it's measured by the moment we finally admit the weight is real.

If no one has told you lately, let me tell you something simple.

You don't have to earn the right to feel what you feel.

You don't need a dramatic story before your sadness becomes valid.

You don't have to compare your wounds to someone else's before you're allowed to acknowledge they hurt.

Pain isn't a competition.

Neither is healing.

Maybe today you'll close this page and nothing will change.

Maybe tomorrow you'll still smile when someone asks if you're okay.

Maybe the world around you will look exactly the same.

But perhaps, for just a moment, you'll remember this:

There are people you've never met who would understand more than you think.

People carrying invisible battles, just like you.

People who learned to smile because they didn't know what else to do.

If you're one of them...

Thank you for making it this far.

Thank you for staying, even on the days when staying felt heavier than leaving.

And if no one has said it today—

I'm glad you're still here.

Until the next letter.

—

LETTER TWO

To the Person Who Never Knew

*"Sometimes the deepest wounds are left by people who never realized they were
holding the knife."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWO

To the Person Who Never Knew

*"Sometimes the deepest wounds are left by people who never realized
they were holding the knife."*

Dear You,

There are things I've rehearsed saying to you so many times that
they've started to sound like memories.

Not conversations.

Just echoes.

The kind that happen while driving home alone.

While standing in the shower.

While staring at the ceiling long after everyone else has fallen
asleep.

I've imagined how you'd respond.

Sometimes you'd apologize.

Sometimes you'd laugh.

Sometimes you'd tell me I was overthinking it.

The truth is, I never gave you the chance to say any of those things.

Because I never spoke.

Not really.

I answered your questions.

I smiled in your photos.

I showed up when I said I would.

But I never told you what was quietly changing inside me.

Maybe that wasn't your fault.

Maybe it wasn't mine either.

Sometimes people drift apart without moving an inch.

You can sit across from someone every day and still feel like you're speaking different languages.

You ask how they're doing.

They say, "I'm okay."

You nod.

The conversation moves on.

Neither of you realizes that was the closest either of you came to telling the truth.

I used to think relationships ended with arguments.

Doors slamming.

Voices raised.

Tears that couldn't be held back.

Now I think most relationships end much more quietly than that.

A message that takes longer to reply to.

Plans that are never rearranged.

Calls that become birthdays.

Birthdays that become memories.

Until one day, you realize you know everything about who they used to be, and almost nothing about who they are now.

No one meant for it to happen.

Life simply kept asking us to choose.

Work.

Responsibilities.

Pride.

Fear.

Tomorrow.

We kept believing there would always be another chance to say what mattered.

It's strange how often we confuse presence with connection.

Just because someone is beside you doesn't mean they can see you.

And just because someone can't see your pain doesn't mean they don't care.

Sometimes they simply don't know where to look.

I wonder how many people are carrying invisible versions of each other.

The friend they wish they'd called.

The parent they never understood until it was too late.

The partner who thought silence meant peace.

The child who only wanted to be noticed.

Maybe we spend too much time assuming people can read what we never write.

Maybe that's why this letter exists.

Not to blame.

Not to ask for another chance.

Only to admit something I've avoided for longer than I care to confess.

There were days I needed someone.

I just didn't know how to become someone who needed help.

So I became easy.

Easy to talk to.

Easy to rely on.

Easy to forget.

It's a dangerous thing, becoming the person who never asks for anything.

People start believing you don't need anyone.

Eventually...

You start believing it too.

If you're reading this while thinking of someone you've slowly lost—

I hope you remember that most distance isn't created by hatred.

It's created by unspoken words.

By waiting one more day.

By assuming they'll understand.

By believing there will always be another conversation.

Sometimes there isn't.

If this letter reminds you of someone, maybe don't wait for the perfect moment.

There rarely is one.

A simple message.

A short phone call.

A quiet, "I've been thinking about you."

Sometimes that's enough to remind someone they're still part of someone's world.

And if you're the one who feels forgotten...

I hope you know that being unseen doesn't make you invisible.

It only means there are parts of you that deserve someone willing
to look a little closer.

Until the next letter.

—

LETTER THREE

To My Younger Self

"I spent years trying to become someone to be proud of, forgetting that the child I once was only wanted someone to be kind."

By Sky하늘

LETTER THREE

To My Younger Self

"I spent years trying to become someone to be proud of, forgetting that the child I once was only wanted someone to be kind."

Dear Younger Me,

I wonder if you'd recognize me now.

Not because I've changed so much.

But because I've become someone you never imagined I'd have to be.

You thought growing up meant having answers.

You believed adults woke up knowing exactly where they were going, what they were doing, and why.

You couldn't wait to become one of them.

If only I could tell you the truth.

Most of us are just children wearing responsibilities that became too heavy to take off.

We're all pretending a little.

Some of us are simply better at hiding it.

You were always in a hurry.

In a hurry to grow.

To be respected.

To be understood.

To finally reach the age where life would make sense.

No one told you that every age comes with a different kind of confusion.

You traded scraped knees for sleepless nights.

School exams for impossible expectations.

Broken toys for broken promises.

The problems changed.

The feeling didn't.

I know there are things you blame yourself for.

Moments you replay.

Words you wish you could take back.

Choices you wonder about when the room is quiet enough for
your thoughts to become louder than the television.

I've learned something about regret.

It never arrives to teach us.

It arrives to convince us that we should have known better.

But how could you?

You made decisions with the heart you had at the time.

With the knowledge you had at the time.

With the fears you carried at the time.

You weren't trying to ruin your life.

You were trying to survive it.

I wish someone had told you that making mistakes isn't proof
that you're failing.

It's proof that you're living.

You spent so much time comparing your beginning to someone
else's middle.

You looked at people who seemed happier.

More successful.

More loved.

You thought they had discovered a secret that somehow skipped over you.

Years later, I realized something.

Everyone is carrying a version of themselves they don't show the world.

The confident person worries they're not enough.

The cheerful one cries in private.

The successful one wonders if they're still chasing the wrong dream.

We are all fighting battles behind closed doors.

Some of us have simply become experts at closing the door quietly.

There are things I wish we had done differently.

I wish we had asked for help sooner.

I wish we had forgiven ourselves faster.

I wish we had spent less time trying to earn everyone's approval.

But if I could change one thing...

It wouldn't be our mistakes.

It would be the way we spoke to ourselves after making them.

No one has ever been as cruel to us as the voice inside our own head.

It remembers every failure.

Every embarrassment.

Every moment we weren't enough.

And somehow, it forgets every reason we kept going.

If you're reading this, maybe you still carry that voice too.

The one that says you should be further ahead.

The one that says everyone else has figured life out.

The one that reminds you of every version of yourself that didn't survive your expectations.

I hope one day you learn what I'm still learning.

You don't have to become extraordinary to deserve kindness.

You don't have to prove your worth before you're allowed to rest.

And you don't have to spend your entire life apologizing for being human.

If I could meet you again...

I wouldn't tell you how your story ends.

I'd simply sit beside you.

Listen.

And remind you that the person you're trying so hard to become...

Would one day look back and realize you were doing the best you could.

Thank you for holding on.

Even when you didn't know what you were holding on for.

Until the next letter.

—

LETTER FOUR

To the Nights I Couldn't Sleep

*"The loudest conversations are often the ones that happen after the world has
gone quiet."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER FOUR

To the Nights I Couldn't Sleep

"The loudest conversations are often the ones that happen after the world has gone quiet."

Dear Night,

You have always known more about me than anyone else.

During the day, I become whoever I need to be.

I answer questions.

I finish my work.

I laugh when everyone else laughs.

I nod when people tell me everything will be okay.

I wear a version of myself that is easy for the world to understand.

Then you arrive.

The room grows quiet.

The phone stops buzzing.

The television goes dark.

There are no more distractions.

Only me.

And every thought I managed to outrun before sunset.

It's strange how memories choose this hour to visit.

The conversation I wish had gone differently.

The message I never replied to.

The apology I never received.

The apology I never gave.

Faces I haven't seen in years suddenly appear as if they never left.

I lie awake wondering whether they ever think of me too.

Maybe they don't.

Maybe that's the hardest part.

Night has a way of asking questions that daylight never has time for.

Are you happy?

Are you becoming the person you wanted to be?

When was the last time you felt completely understood?

Some nights, I answer.

Most nights, I turn over my pillow and pretend sleep will arrive before honesty does.

People often say they miss being young.

I don't think that's what we miss.

I think we miss how simple life used to feel.

Back when tomorrow only meant another school day.

Back when love wasn't complicated.

Back when saying goodbye didn't always mean forever.

Somewhere along the way, life became a collection of unfinished conversations.

And maybe that's why we're here.

Writing letters we'll never send.

Trying to give words a home because they were never welcomed anywhere else.

I wonder how many people are awake with us right now.

A student staring at the ceiling before an exam.

A father worrying about bills.

A mother sitting beside a hospital bed.

Someone scrolling through old photos they promised themselves they had deleted.

Someone rereading a message from a person who no longer belongs in their life.

Someone whispering, "*I'm okay*," to an empty room.

We are strangers.

Yet somehow, we share the same silence.

I used to believe that healing arrived all at once.

Like sunrise.

Now I think it arrives more quietly than that.

It's choosing to get out of bed after a difficult night.

It's replying to a message you've been avoiding.

It's making yourself breakfast even when you don't feel hungry.

It's opening the curtains.

It's taking a deep breath before stepping outside.

Healing rarely announces itself.

It hides inside ordinary moments.

Maybe that's why we overlook it.

Maybe we're waiting for fireworks while life keeps offering us
candles.

If tonight feels heavier than usual...

You don't have to solve your entire life before morning.

You don't have to untangle every memory before you close your
eyes.

Sometimes surviving the night is enough.

Sometimes the bravest thing you can do is promise yourself one
more sunrise.

And if sleep refuses to visit...

I hope these words can keep you company for a little while.

Until the sky begins to change.

Until the birds remember how to sing.

Until the world becomes loud enough to drown out the thoughts
that only darkness seems to understand.

Goodnight.

I'll leave the light on a little longer.

Until the next letter.

—

LETTER FIVE

To the Days I Pretended

"Some masks become so familiar that we forget there was ever a face beneath them."

By Sky하늘

LETTER FIVE

To the Days I Pretended

*"Some masks become so familiar that we forget there was ever a face
beneath them."*

Dear You,

I'm tired.

Not in the way people usually mean it.

I've slept for eight hours and still felt exhausted.

I've taken days off and returned just as empty.

I've smiled through conversations while quietly counting the minutes until I could be alone again.

It's a strange kind of tired.

The kind that isn't cured by rest.

Only honesty.

But honesty is difficult.

People ask, "How are you?"

Not because they're careless.

Because it's what we've all learned to say.

And somewhere along the way, we all agreed on the same answer.

"I'm fine."

It's amazing how two simple words can hide an entire life.

"I'm fine."

It can mean...

"I cried before leaving the house."

"I haven't felt like myself for months."

"I don't know how to explain what's happening."

"I don't want to worry you."

"I don't think you'd understand."

Or maybe...

"I don't understand it myself."

The older I get, the more I realize that pretending isn't always lying.

Sometimes it's survival.

Sometimes we smile because we're trying to convince ourselves.

Sometimes we laugh because if we don't, we'll fall apart in front of people who aren't expecting to catch us.

I've done that more times than I can remember.

Smiled in photographs I didn't want to be in.

Celebrated milestones while wondering why they felt so empty.

Sat at crowded tables and somehow felt completely alone.

No one noticed.

Not because they didn't care.

Because I had become very good at looking okay.

There's something dangerous about becoming "the strong one."

People admire your calm.

They trust your advice.

They lean on your shoulders when life becomes too heavy.

And you let them.

Because helping others gives you a reason to ignore the cracks in yourself.

Until one day...

You realize you've built a home for everyone except the person living inside your own heart.

Maybe you've been there.

The friend everyone calls first.

The one who listens.

The one who comforts.

The one who always says, "I'll be alright."

Yet when the room is finally quiet...

You don't know who to call.

You scroll through your contacts.

You think of sending a message.

Then you delete it.

You convince yourself they'll probably be busy.

You tell yourself you'll feel better tomorrow.

Sometimes you do.

Sometimes tomorrow becomes another day of pretending.

I wonder how many people we've walked past without realizing
they were carrying invisible storms.

The cashier who smiled at us.

The colleague who joked through the meeting.

The stranger who held the door open.

We never really know what someone had to survive before they
crossed our path.

Maybe that's why kindness matters so much.

Not because it changes the world overnight.

But because we rarely know whose world is quietly falling apart.

If you've spent years pretending...

I hope you don't mistake your ability to endure for your
obligation to keep suffering in silence.

You are allowed to be tired.

You are allowed to admit that some days are harder than others.

You are allowed to say, "I'm not okay."

Those words don't make you weak.

They make you honest.

And sometimes honesty is the first place healing learns your name.

If today is one of those days...

The kind where your smile feels heavier than your sadness...

You don't have to convince this page that you're okay.

You never did.

Until the next letter.

—

LETTER SIX

To the Goodbyes We Never Prepared For

*"No one teaches us how to mourn the things that are still alive, but no longer
ours."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER SIX

To the Goodbyes We Never Prepared For

"No one teaches us how to mourn the things that are still alive, but no longer ours."

Dear You,

I used to think goodbyes were obvious.

I imagined they arrived with final conversations.

Long embraces.

Tears that warned us this would be the last time.

Life has taught me something different.

Most goodbyes don't announce themselves.

Sometimes the last time you laugh with someone feels completely ordinary.

You don't stop to remember the moment.

You don't take one more photograph.

You don't hug them a little longer.

Because how could you know?

How could anyone know that an ordinary Tuesday would quietly become a memory?

There are people I thought I'd always know.

Friends whose numbers I no longer recognize.

Neighbours who moved away.

Teachers whose voices I can still hear but whose faces have begun to blur.

Some didn't leave because they wanted to.

Some simply followed the direction life was pulling them.

And somehow, that was enough.

The hardest goodbyes aren't always to people.

Sometimes we grieve places.

The house that no longer belongs to our family.

The café where we once waited for someone who never arrived.

The road we used to drive before life changed.

Even a song can become a place we can't return to without feeling something we thought had already healed.

It's strange what the heart decides to keep.

A scent.

A season.

A sentence.

A laugh.

A rainy afternoon.

Details that seemed insignificant at the time somehow become the only things we have left.

I used to fight memories.

I wanted them to disappear.

I believed forgetting meant moving on.

Now I understand that forgetting was never the goal.

Some people deserve to be remembered.

Some chapters deserve to hurt a little.

Not because we enjoy the pain...

But because pain is proof that something once mattered.

There are losses we speak about openly.

And then there are the quiet ones.

The dream that never happened.

The career we never pursued.

The family we imagined.

The apology we waited for.

The version of ourselves we thought we'd become by now.

Those losses rarely receive flowers.

No one sends a card that says,

"I'm sorry your life didn't unfold the way you hoped."

So, we carry those goodbyes alone.

Invisible.

Unnamed.

Heavy.

Maybe you're carrying one too.

Maybe you're mourning someone who is still alive but no longer part of your story.

Maybe you're grieving the person you used to be before life became complicated.

Or maybe...

You're simply trying to make peace with the fact that not everything beautiful is meant to stay.

If that's where you are...

Don't rush yourself.

The world often treats healing like a deadline.

As though there's a correct amount of time to miss someone.

As though memories should expire.

They don't.

Some names become softer.

Some scars fade.

But love, in all its forms, leaves fingerprints.

And perhaps that's not something we should be ashamed of.

One day, you'll remember someone without feeling your chest tighten.

One day, a song will play, and you'll smile before you cry.

One day, you'll realize the memory no longer feels like an open wound.

It feels like a quiet thank you.

For the time you had.

For the person you became.

For the love that existed, even if it couldn't stay.

Until then...

Be gentle with yourself.

Some goodbyes take longer to understand than they do to happen.

Until the next letter.

—

LETTER SEVEN

To the Voice Inside My Head

"The longest conversation I'll ever have is the one I have with myself."

By Sky하늘

LETTER SEVEN

To the Voice Inside My Head

"The longest conversation I'll ever have is the one I have with myself."

Dear You,

Have you noticed how gently we speak to strangers?

Someone drops their coffee.

We smile and tell them it's okay.

A friend makes a mistake.

We remind them that everyone does.

A child falls while learning to ride a bicycle.

We tell them to get back up because falling is part of learning.

We offer patience so naturally.

Grace comes easily when the pain belongs to someone else.

But when it's our turn...

The voice changes.

"You should have known better."

"Why would you say something so stupid?"

"Look at everyone else. They're doing just fine."

"You'll never be enough."

It's strange, isn't it?

We become the one person we'd never allow anyone else to be.

Our own harshest critic.

Our own impossible standard.

I wonder where that voice came from.

Maybe it was born from expectations.

Maybe from comparisons.

Maybe from years of believing that mistakes were something to hide instead of something to learn from.

Or maybe...

It grew quietly.

One disappointment at a time.

One failure at a time.

One comment we never forgot.

The world has a way of moving on from our mistakes much faster than we do.

People forget what we said.

They forget the awkward moment.

The failed interview.

The wrong answer.

The embarrassing fall.

But we remember.

We collect those moments like stones in our pockets.

Small at first.

Almost weightless.

Until one day we wonder why we're so exhausted just from carrying ourselves.

I used to believe confidence meant never doubting yourself.

Now I think confidence is something much quieter.

It's hearing that cruel voice...

And choosing not to believe everything it says.

Because the truth is...

That voice isn't always honest.

It remembers every failure.

Yet somehow forgets every time we got back up.

It remembers every goodbye.

Yet forgets every person who stayed.

It remembers every rejection.

Yet ignores every reason someone chose us.

It's a poor historian.

It only keeps the chapters that hurt.

Maybe that's why we have to become the editor of our own story.

Not by erasing the difficult pages.

But by refusing to let them become the entire book.

You're more than your worst decision.

More than your lowest season.

More than the dream that didn't work out.

More than the relationship that ended.

More than the words you wish you could take back.

If someone you loved described themselves the way you describe yourself...

Would you let them?

Would you stand there while they called themselves a failure?

Would you stay silent while they convinced themselves they weren't worth loving?

I don't think you would.

So why is it acceptable when the voice belongs to you?

Perhaps kindness doesn't begin with how we treat others.

Perhaps it begins with the conversations no one else can hear.

The ones that happen while we're brushing our teeth.

Driving home.

Lying awake in bed.

Looking into a mirror.

Maybe healing starts the day we stop demanding perfection from a person who has only ever been trying to survive.

Maybe it begins with replacing one sentence.

Not...

"I should have been better."

But...

"I didn't know then what I know now."

There is a difference.

One sentence is punishment.

The other is compassion.

And if you're anything like me...

Compassion might feel unfamiliar at first.

That's okay.

Anything worth learning usually does.

So the next time that voice tells you you're not enough...

Pause.

Ask yourself a simple question.

"Would I say this to someone I love?"

If the answer is no...

Maybe you shouldn't say it to yourself either.

After all...

You've been carrying yourself through every storm you've ever survived.

That deserves more gratitude than criticism.

Until the next letter.

—

"Be careful how you speak to yourself.

You're listening."

LETTER EIGHT

To the Person Slowly Disappearing

*"The hardest part wasn't feeling invisible. It was realizing I had slowly
become invisible to myself."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER EIGHT

To the Person Slowly Disappearing

*"The hardest part wasn't feeling invisible. It was realizing I had slowly
become invisible to myself."*

Dear You,

I wonder when it started.

Not the sadness.

Not the loneliness.

The disappearing.

Because people imagine it happens all at once.

Like a light switch.

One day you're here.

The next, you're gone.

But that's not how it happened.

At least...

Not for me.

It happened quietly.

So quietly that I didn't notice pieces of myself going missing.

I stopped listening to songs that once made me feel alive.

I stopped laughing without thinking.

I stopped making plans for months that hadn't happened yet.

I stopped looking forward to things.

Not because life became terrible.

Because it slowly became...

empty.

There's a strange kind of loneliness that exists even in crowded places.

You can sit beside people you love...

Hear them laugh.

Watch them tell stories.

Smile when they smile.

And still feel like you're watching life through a window.

You're there.

But not really.

You're participating.

Without belonging.

No one notices.

Because you still answer when someone calls your name.

You still go to work.

You still reply to messages.

You still remember birthdays.

From the outside...

Everything looks normal.

Maybe that's why it's so difficult to explain.

How do you describe disappearing...

When your body is still here?

People ask what happened.

I wish I knew.

Nothing dramatic.

No single moment.

No catastrophe.

Just...

days.

One ordinary day after another.

Until ordinary became unbearable.

I started saying "maybe next time" more often.

Not because I didn't want to go.

Because I didn't have the energy to explain why I couldn't.

I cancelled plans.

Then people stopped inviting me.

Not out of anger.

Out of understanding.

Eventually...

Silence became expected.

I told myself I liked being alone.

Maybe I did.

But there's a difference between choosing solitude...

And believing no one would notice if you disappeared.

That thought frightened me.

Not because I wanted to leave.

Because I couldn't remember the last time I truly felt present.

I missed myself.

Have you ever missed someone...

Only to realize the person you were looking for...

Was the version of yourself from years ago?

The one who laughed too loudly.

Who believed weekends lasted forever.

Who thought healing happened naturally with time.

I think about that person sometimes.

I wonder if they'd recognize me.

Or if they'd ask...

"What happened to us?"

I don't think I'd have an answer.

Only silence.

Maybe that's what depression feels like for some people.

Not constant crying.

Not dramatic heartbreak.

Just the slow erosion of colour.

Food still tastes like food.

The sun still rises.

People still tell jokes.

But somehow...

Everything arrives without reaching you.

Like hearing music through a wall.

You know it's there.

You just can't feel it anymore.

If you've ever felt this...

Please know something.

You are not strange.

You are not weak.

And you are certainly not alone.

There are people walking through supermarkets...

Sitting in classrooms...

Driving home from work...

Smiling in family photographs...

Who are quietly asking themselves the same question.

"When did I stop feeling like myself?"

Maybe we won't find the answer tonight.

Maybe there isn't one.

But perhaps the first step isn't becoming who we used to be.

Perhaps it's simply noticing...

That somewhere beneath the exhaustion...

Beneath the numbness...

Beneath the silence...

There is still someone worth finding.

Even if they feel impossibly far away.

So if all you did today was survive...

If all you managed was getting out of bed...

If breathing felt like the only thing you accomplished...

Please don't call that "nothing."

Some days...

Survival is the bravest thing a person can do.

And some people will never know how much courage it took for you to make it to tomorrow.

I'm glad you did.

Even if you don't fully understand why yet.

Until the next letter.

—

"Sometimes, healing doesn't begin with hope.

It begins with staying."

LETTER NINE

To the One Who Always Stayed Strong

*"The strongest people are often the ones who secretly wish someone would ask
if they're okay and wait long enough to hear the real answer."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER NINE

To the One Who Always Stayed Strong

"The strongest people are often the ones who secretly wish someone would ask if they're okay and wait long enough to hear the real answer."

Dear You,

You became the strong one.

I don't know when it happened.

Maybe it was after the first time someone leaned on you.

Maybe it was after you realized people only seemed comfortable when you looked unshaken.

Or maybe...

It happened so slowly that you never noticed.

One day, people started coming to you with their problems.

You listened.

You stayed.

You reminded them they weren't alone.

And somewhere between comforting everyone else...

You forgot what it felt like to be comforted.

People say you're strong.

I wonder if they've ever asked what that strength has cost you.

Because strength is expensive.

Sometimes it costs sleep.

Sometimes it costs peace.

Sometimes it costs the version of you that used to believe you didn't have to carry everything alone.

You became the person who says,

"Don't worry about me."

Even when you wished someone would.

You learned to smile before anyone had the chance to ask why you looked different.

You answered,

"It's nothing."

Because explaining felt heavier than pretending.

I wonder how many times you've sat in your car for a few extra minutes before going inside.

Not because you had somewhere else to be.

Because you needed a moment where no one expected anything from you.

Just one quiet moment.

No conversations.

No responsibilities.

No version of yourself to perform.

Just...

Silence.

Have you noticed how the world celebrates people who keep going?

"You're so resilient."

"You're always there for everyone."

"I don't know how you do it."

They mean well.

But sometimes those compliments become invisible cages.

Because once people believe you're unbreakable...

They stop checking whether you've started to crack.

The hardest part isn't carrying other people's pain.

It's convincing yourself that yours can wait.

So you postpone it.

Until after work.

After the weekend.

After the bills are paid.

After everyone else is okay.

After...

After...

After.

One day you wake up and realize you've postponed yourself for years.

There's a quiet loneliness in being the dependable one.

People know your kindness.

They know your patience.

They know you'll answer the phone.

But very few know what happens after you hang up.

How quiet the room becomes.

How heavy your own thoughts can feel.

How often you've whispered,

"I'm tired."

To a room that couldn't answer.

Maybe that's why this letter exists.

Not to tell you to stop being kind.

The world needs kind people.

But kindness shouldn't become another word for self-neglect.

You deserve the same compassion you give away so freely.

The same patience.

The same understanding.

The same chance to fall apart without apologizing for making a mess.

If you're reading this...

I hope you remember something.

Being the strong one doesn't mean you have to carry every storm by yourself.

Even mountains crumble.

Even oceans have quiet days.

Even hearts that have held so much for so long deserve somewhere safe to rest.

Maybe...

Just maybe...

That place can begin with you.

Until the next letter.

—

LETTER TEN

To the Person I Became While Trying to Be Loved

"I kept changing so you would stay. Somewhere along the way, I became a stranger to myself."

By Sky하늘

LETTER TEN

To the Person I Became While Trying to Be Loved

*"I kept changing so you would stay. Somewhere along the way, I
became a stranger to myself."*

Dear You,

I used to think love meant becoming whatever someone needed.

If they liked quiet...

I became quieter.

If they liked confidence...

I pretended I had more than I did.

If they needed someone strong...

I hid every part of me that looked like it might break.

It felt like love.

At least...

That's what I called it.

Looking back, I don't think I was searching for love.

I was searching for permission.

Permission to believe I was enough.

And if changing myself meant earning that feeling...

Then changing didn't seem like such a high price.

At first, the changes were small.

I laughed at jokes I didn't find funny.

I apologized for things that weren't my fault.

I stopped mentioning the music I loved because someone once called it childish.

I stopped wearing clothes that made me feel like myself because they weren't "their style."

Little things.

Almost invisible.

The kind of things no one notices.

Not even you.

Until one day...

You look in the mirror.

And the face looking back is familiar.

But the person isn't.

People often ask,

"Why didn't you just leave?"

As if leaving is something that happens in one brave moment.

It isn't.

Sometimes you don't notice you're disappearing until there's almost nothing left to save.

Sometimes the hardest prison isn't the one someone builds around you.

It's the one you build inside yourself.

Brick by brick.

Compromise by compromise.

You tell yourself,

"It's not a big deal."

"Relationships require sacrifice."

"Maybe I'm asking for too much."

Eventually...

You stop asking altogether.

The strange thing is...

No one else can hear the negotiations happening inside your heart.

They don't see the words you swallow.

The opinions you soften.

The dreams you quietly place back on the shelf because you're afraid they'll take up too much space.

From the outside...

You still look like yourself.

Inside...

You've been packing your belongings for years.

I wish someone had told me this sooner.

Real love doesn't ask you to become smaller.

It doesn't reward silence.

It doesn't make you feel guilty for having needs.

Love should feel like taking a deep breath.

Not holding one.

And if someone only loves the version of you that never disagrees...

Never cries...

Never struggles...

Then perhaps they never met the real you at all.

Maybe that's why losing yourself happens so quietly.

Because no one applauds the moment you abandon your own voice.

No one notices when you choose someone else's happiness over your own for the hundredth time.

The world only notices when you finally say,

"I can't do this anymore."

They call it sudden.

But you know better.

You were leaving in pieces long before you walked away.

If you're reading this while trying to become easier to love...

Please stop for a moment.

Ask yourself a question.

If love requires you to hide the parts of yourself that need love
the most...

Is it really love?

Or is it fear wearing love's clothes?

I don't know who needs to hear this.

Maybe you.

Maybe me.

Maybe the version of us that still believes we have to earn our
place in someone's heart.

But listen carefully.

You were never too much.

You were only asking the wrong people to see you.

One day...

Someone will meet the version of you that doesn't apologize for
existing.

The version that laughs too loudly.

Talks too much.

Dreams too big.

Feels too deeply.

And instead of asking you to become less...

They'll make you wonder why you ever believed you had to.

Until that day...

Choose yourself.

Not because you're giving up on love.

But because love should never begin with losing who you are.

Until the next letter.

—

LETTER ELEVEN

To the Days I Couldn't Recognize Myself

"The scariest part of losing yourself isn't forgetting who you were. It's getting used to living as someone you've never met."

By Sky하늘

LETTER ELEVEN

To the Days I Couldn't Recognize Myself

*"The scariest part of losing yourself isn't forgetting who you were. It's
getting used to living as someone you've never met."*

Dear You,

I caught my reflection today.

For a moment...

I didn't recognize the person looking back.

Not because my face had changed.

Because something behind my eyes had.

I stood there longer than I meant to.

Wondering.

Not who I was.

But where I had gone.

...

People think losing yourself is dramatic.

They imagine a tragedy.

A heartbreak.

A single day that changes everything.

But I don't think that's how it happens.

I think we disappear quietly.

One habit at a time.

One disappointment at a time.

One compromise at a time.

Until the person we used to be becomes someone we remember
instead of someone we are.

...

I miss the version of me that found joy in small things.

A song.

The smell of rain.

A late-night drive.

A message from a friend.

I don't know where that version went.

Maybe life became louder.

Maybe responsibilities spoke over happiness.

Maybe I simply stopped listening.

...

There are days when I answer every message.

Finish every task.

Smile at every conversation.

And somehow...

Feel absolutely nothing.

Not sadness.

Not happiness.

Just...

Silence.

People rarely talk about numbness.

It's difficult to explain.

How do you describe an emptiness that doesn't hurt...

But doesn't let you feel alive either?

It's like standing in the rain...

Without getting wet.

Watching life happen...

Without ever stepping into it.

...

Sometimes I wonder if people notice.

Not the smile.

Not the words.

The absence.

The parts of me that slowly stopped showing up.

The hobbies I abandoned.

The dreams I no longer mention.

The excitement that quietly packed its bags without saying
goodbye.

Maybe they don't.

Maybe I became too good at pretending.

...

The strange thing about surviving...

Is that eventually people stop asking if you're okay.

Because surviving looks so much like living from the outside.

...

I've been told to "stay positive."

To "think differently."

To "focus on the good things."

I know those words come from kindness.

But some storms don't disappear because someone points at the
sunshine.

Some storms ask only one thing.

To be acknowledged.

To have someone sit beside them without trying to fix the
weather.

...

If you've been feeling like this...

Please don't punish yourself for not feeling like the person you used to be.

People change.

Hearts become tired.

Minds become overwhelmed.

None of that makes you broken.

It makes you human.

...

Maybe healing doesn't begin when you find yourself again.

Maybe it begins the moment you stop pretending you were never lost.

Maybe that's enough for today.

Just admitting it.

Without shame.

Without guilt.

Without apologizing.

...

If no one has told you this recently...

You don't have to become the person you were five years ago.

You don't owe yesterday your entire future.

The version of you waiting ahead may not look like the one
you've been searching for.

And that's okay.

Some people aren't meant to return to who they were.

They're meant to become someone they can finally be gentle
with.

Until the next letter.

—

*"If you ever wake up and feel like you've lost yourself
don't begin by searching for the person you used to be.
Begin by listening to the person who's still here."*

LETTER TWELVE

To the Tomorrow I Stopped Waiting For

*"Some mornings aren't difficult because life is hard. They're difficult because
hope feels so far away."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWELVE

To the Tomorrow I Stopped Waiting For

*"Some mornings aren't difficult because life is hard. They're difficult
because hope feels so far away."*

Dear You,

There was a time when tomorrow meant something.

A birthday.

A trip.

A dream.

A reason to count the days.

Now...

Tomorrow arrives so quietly that sometimes I don't notice it
becoming today.

Morning.

Coffee.

Work.

Home.

Sleep.

Repeat.

Days begin to stack on top of each other until I can't remember whether I'm living them...

Or simply surviving them.

...

People ask,

"How have you been?"

I usually answer,

"Busy."

It's easier.

Busy sounds productive.

Busy sounds healthy.

Busy doesn't make people worry.

What I don't tell them...

Is that sometimes being busy is just another way of avoiding the silence.

Because silence asks questions.

Questions I'm not always ready to answer.

...

When did I stop looking forward to weekends?

When did my favourite songs become background noise?

When did laughter start feeling like something I borrowed instead of something I owned?

I wish I could point to one moment.

One reason.

One explanation.

But life rarely gives us that.

Sometimes there isn't a storm.

Only years of standing in the rain.

...

There are evenings when I sit in my room with nothing to do.

I could watch a movie.

Read a book.

Call someone.

Go for a walk.

Instead...

I sit.

Not because I want to.

Because I don't have the energy to want anything.

People often mistake this feeling for laziness.

It isn't.

Laziness is choosing not to move.

This...

Feels like forgetting how.

...

The hardest part isn't the exhaustion.

It's pretending that exhaustion has a reason people will accept.

If I say,

"I'm tired from work,"

Everyone understands.

If I say,

"I'm tired from carrying my own thoughts,"

The room becomes quiet.

Some kinds of tiredness don't have polite names.

...

I've spent so much time waiting to feel like myself again...

That I forgot to ask whether I was giving myself permission to become someone new.

Maybe that's what I've been grieving.

Not the past.

But the expectation that I'd always be the same person.

...

If today felt ordinary...

Please don't underestimate it.

There are people who smiled today even though their hearts felt unbearably heavy.

People who answered every message while quietly wondering why everything feels so distant.

People who kept moving simply because stopping felt even harder.

Maybe you're one of them.

If you are...

I hope you know that surviving an ordinary day can require extraordinary courage.

No one gives awards for that.

No one applauds it.

But that doesn't make it any less real.

...

I don't know what tomorrow looks like for you.

Maybe it feels exciting.

Maybe it feels frightening.

Or maybe...

It feels like just another square on the calendar.

Whatever tomorrow becomes...

You don't have to carry the entire week tonight.

You don't have to solve your whole life before you fall asleep.

Sometimes the bravest promise we can make is a small one.

"I'll meet tomorrow... when tomorrow arrives."

Nothing more.

Nothing less.

Until the next letter.

—

"You don't have to love tomorrow.

*You only have to believe that you deserve the chance to see
it."*

LETTER THIRTEEN

To the Anger I Never Understood

*"I thought I had an anger problem. It took me years to realize my sadness
had simply forgotten how to speak."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER THIRTEEN

To the Anger I Never Understood

*"I thought I had an anger problem. It took me years to realize my
sadness had simply forgotten how to speak."*

Dear You,

I used to believe I was an angry person.

Not the kind who shouted.

Not the kind who threw things across the room.

My anger was quieter than that.

It lived in my patience.

Or rather...

The patience I no longer had.

...

I became irritated by the smallest things.

A slow reply.

A loud voice.

Traffic.

A forgotten promise.

Someone asking,

"What's wrong?"

On the surface...

None of it seemed important.

Yet somehow...

Everything felt heavy.

...

I kept telling myself,

"I need to control my temper."

So I apologized.

Again.

And again.

And again.

But every apology felt incomplete.

Because I wasn't apologizing for anger.

I was apologizing for pain that had found the wrong language.

...

No one ever teaches us what grief looks like when it isn't crying.

Sometimes...

It sounds like frustration.

Sometimes...

It looks like distance.

Sometimes...

It becomes silence.

And sometimes...

It wears the face of anger.

...

I think there comes a point when the heart grows tired of
whispering.

So it begins knocking louder.

Not because it wants to hurt anyone.

Because it wants to be heard.

...

Looking back...

I wasn't angry that people made mistakes.

I was angry that I always felt alone while carrying mine.

I wasn't angry because life was unfair.

I was angry because I kept pretending it didn't hurt.

I wasn't angry at the people I loved.

I was angry that I no longer recognized the person I became around them.

There is a difference.

I wish someone had told me that sooner.

...

One day...

Someone asked me,

"When was the last time you truly rested?"

I laughed.

Not because it was funny.

Because I couldn't remember.

Maybe exhaustion had been borrowing my voice all along.

Maybe burnout had been introducing itself as anger.

Maybe loneliness had been raising its hand...

And I kept calling it something else.

...

The truth is...

Emotions don't disappear because we ignore them.

They simply change their clothes.

The tears we refuse to cry...

Become sharp words.

The fears we refuse to face...

Become control.

The disappointments we never speak about...

Become resentment.

The loneliness we hide...

Becomes distance.

Our hearts always find a way to speak.

The question is...

Will we listen before they have to shout?

...

If you've been calling yourself "an angry person"...

Pause for a moment.

Ask a different question.

What is my anger protecting?

Not defending.

Protecting.

Because anger is rarely the first emotion to arrive.

It's usually the guard standing at the door.

Behind it...

There may be grief.

Fear.

Shame.

Loneliness.

Disappointment.

Or simply...

A tired heart that has carried too much for too long.

...

Perhaps healing doesn't begin by learning how to suppress your anger.

Perhaps it begins by introducing yourself to the emotion that arrived before it.

The one that never had the chance to be heard.

The one still waiting...

Patiently...

Behind the noise.

Until the next letter.

—

*"Anger is often grief that never believed it would be safe
enough to cry."*

LETTER FOURTEEN

To the Child Who Learned to Need Less

*"Some children don't lose their innocence. They lose the belief that someone
will always be there when they need them."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER FOURTEEN

To the Child Who Learned to Need Less

*"Some children don't lose their innocence. They lose the belief that
someone will always be there when they need them."*

Dear You,

I don't remember deciding to become easy.

I don't remember waking up one morning and thinking,

"From today onward... I'll stop asking for too much."

I think it happened quietly.

Like most things that change us.

...

Maybe it was the first time I saw someone sigh after I asked for help.

Maybe it was the moment I realized everyone already had enough to carry.

Maybe no one meant to teach me this lesson.

Maybe life did.

...

So I learned.

I learned how to wait.

How to solve my own problems.

How to tell people,

"Don't worry about me."

Even when I wished they would.

...

Some people grow up believing the world is a safe place to fall.

Others...

Learn how to land before anyone notices they've slipped.

...

I became independent.

People admired that.

They called me responsible.

Mature.

Reliable.

They said,

"You're so easy to deal with."

I smiled.

I said thank you.

I didn't know how to tell them...

That being easy had never been my dream.

It had simply become my survival.

...

The strange thing about carrying everything yourself...

Is that eventually people believe you always can.

Not because they don't care.

Because you've spent years convincing them you don't need anyone.

...

I wonder how many times someone almost helped me...

But stopped.

Because I looked fine.

Because I said,

"I've got it."

Because I had become so practiced at hiding my need...

That even kindness couldn't find where to begin.

...

Sometimes I envy people who ask for help without apologizing.

Who cry without feeling guilty.

Who admit they're overwhelmed before they collapse.

Not because they're weaker.

Because somewhere along the way...

They learned that being loved wasn't something they had to earn
by being low maintenance.

...

I've spent years trying not to inconvenience anyone.

Walking a little quieter.

Speaking a little softer.

Needing a little less.

Until one day...

I realized I had made myself so small...

That even I struggled to find myself.

...

Maybe that's why receiving love has always felt uncomfortable.

When someone offers kindness...

Part of me wonders what they expect in return.

When someone says,

"You can call me anytime."

A voice inside whispers,

"Don't be a burden."

It's strange how lessons learned in silence...

Can keep speaking for decades.

...

If any of this feels familiar...

I hope you hear something your younger self may have needed.

You were never difficult for having needs.

You were never "too much" for wanting comfort.

You were never weak for hoping someone would stay.

Children aren't meant to carry adulthood before they understand childhood.

And adults...

Aren't meant to carry every burden alone.

...

Maybe healing isn't learning to become stronger.

Maybe you've been strong for far too long.

Maybe healing is learning that you don't have to deserve kindness before receiving it.

Maybe...

Just maybe...

You can let someone hold part of the weight.

Without apologizing for how heavy it is.

Until the next letter.

—

*"The child who learned to need less often grows into the
adult who believes they deserve less.*

Neither of them was ever asking for too much."

LETTER FIFTEEN

To the Dreams I Quietly Buried

*"Not every dream dies. Some simply become too quiet to hear beneath the
noise of survival."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER FIFTEEN

To the Dreams I Quietly Buried

*"Not every dream dies. Some simply become too quiet to hear beneath
the noise of survival."*

Dear You,

Someone once asked me what I wanted to be.

The answer came so quickly.

As if my heart had been waiting for someone to ask.

I spoke with certainty.

With excitement.

With the kind of confidence only someone untouched by
disappointment can have.

...

Years passed.

Someone asked me the same question again.

This time...

I paused.

Not because I didn't have dreams.

Because I wasn't sure if I was still allowed to say them out loud.

...

Life has a quiet way of changing our vocabulary.

We stop saying,

"One day, I will."

And start saying,

"Maybe someday."

Then...

"We'll see."

Until eventually...

We stop answering the question altogether.

...

No one tells you that survival can become so loud...

That your dreams slowly lose their voice.

Not because you stopped believing in them.

Because there was always something more urgent.

Bills.

Responsibilities.

People depending on you.

A future that demanded certainty...

When all your dreams ever asked for...

Was a little courage.

...

I don't remember the day I buried them.

There wasn't a ceremony.

No final goodbye.

No dramatic decision.

Just...

Another year.

Another excuse.

Another promise to myself that I'd come back when life became less busy.

Life never did.

...

Sometimes I wonder where those dreams go.

Do they wait?

Do they disappear?

Or do they quietly follow us...

Becoming a small ache every time we see someone else living the life we once imagined?

...

I used to mistake that ache for jealousy.

Now I think it was grief.

Not because I wanted their life.

Because somewhere inside it...

I caught a glimpse of the person I almost became.

...

There's a strange sadness in outgrowing a dream.

But there's an even quieter sadness...

In abandoning one before you've given it a chance to disappoint you.

Fear has a convincing voice.

It tells us we're too late.

Too ordinary.

Too inexperienced.

Too busy.

Too old.

Too young.

Too much.

Not enough.

It never runs out of reasons.

...

One day I opened an old notebook.

Between its pages...

I found a list of goals I had written years before.

Some made me smile.

Some made me laugh.

One of them made me cry.

Not because it was impossible.

Because I remembered the person who wrote it.

They believed the world was still listening.

...

I wanted to tell that younger version of me something.

Not,

"Everything will work out."

Life doesn't make promises like that.

I wanted to say,

"Please don't confuse a delayed dream with a dead one."

There's a difference.

One asks for patience.

The other asks for surrender.

Too often...

We mistake one for the other.

...

Maybe your dream has changed.

Maybe it no longer fits the person you've become.

That's okay.

Dreams are allowed to grow with us.

But don't let fear make that decision for you.

Don't let exhaustion convince you that wanting more is childish.

Don't let survival become the only story your life gets to tell.

...

Tonight...

Before you go to sleep...

Ask yourself a question.

Not,

"What do I need to achieve?"

Ask,

"What have I stopped believing was possible?"

Sit with the answer.

Don't judge it.

Don't explain it away.

Just...

Listen.

Some dreams don't need a miracle.

They only need to be remembered.

Until the next letter.

—

"Growing older is inevitable.

Growing smaller is not.

*Protect the part of you that still dares to imagine a different
tomorrow."*

LETTER SIXTEEN

To the People I Couldn't Save

*"Some of the deepest guilt comes from believing love should have been enough
to change someone else's story."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER SIXTEEN

To the People I Couldn't Save

"Some of the deepest guilt comes from believing love should have been enough to change someone else's story."

Dear You,

For a long time...

I believed that if I cared enough...

People would stay.

If I listened longer...

They would heal.

If I loved harder...

Things would somehow become different.

...

So I stayed.

Long after I was exhausted.

Long after the conversations began repeating themselves.

Long after I stopped recognizing the difference between helping someone...

And carrying them.

...

It didn't happen because I wanted to be a hero.

It happened because I couldn't bear the thought of losing someone while wondering if I could have done more.

That question...

"Could I have done more?"

Has a way of following you.

It waits until the room is quiet.

Then it sits beside you.

...

I replay conversations.

Searching for different words.

Different choices.

Different endings.

As though memory were a puzzle I could finally solve if I looked at it one more time.

But memories don't work that way.

They don't change because we revisit them.

Only we do.

...

There were people I wanted to rescue.

Not from danger.

From loneliness.

From fear.

From the battles they never spoke about.

I thought if I stood beside them long enough...

They would eventually see what I saw.

That they mattered.

That they were loved.

That they weren't alone.

...

Sometimes they believed me.

Sometimes they didn't.

And for years...

I blamed myself for the difference.

...

No one tells you how quietly guilt grows.

It doesn't arrive all at once.

It settles into ordinary thoughts.

"Maybe I should have called."

"Maybe I should have noticed sooner."

"Maybe if I had been stronger..."

Maybe.

Maybe.

Maybe.

It's a word that never runs out of endings.

...

One day...

Someone told me something I wasn't ready to hear.

"You can walk beside someone.

You cannot walk for them."

At first...

I resisted those words.

They sounded like giving up.

Now...

I hear something different.

They sound like acceptance.

...

Love is powerful.

But it is not control.

It cannot make someone forgive themselves.

It cannot force someone to stay.

It cannot carry a burden another heart refuses to set down.

Sometimes...

The kindest thing love can do...

Is remain present without trying to become the solution.

...

I wish I had understood that earlier.

I spent so much time trying to become someone's safe place...

That I forgot I needed one too.

I became so focused on holding everyone else together...

I never noticed the cracks in my own hands.

...

If you're carrying guilt for someone you couldn't save...

Please be gentle with yourself.

You are not responsible for every ending.

You are not measured by every goodbye.

And you are not a failure because your love had limits.

Every human heart does.

...

There is courage in showing up.

There is kindness in staying.

There is beauty in trying.

But there is also wisdom...

In understanding where your responsibility ends...

And another person's journey begins.

...

Maybe the people you couldn't save...

Still changed you.

Maybe they taught you how deeply you could care.

How fiercely you could hope.

How completely you could love.

Perhaps that isn't failure.

Perhaps...

That's simply what it means to have a heart.

Until the next letter.

—

*"Some people leave our lives carrying the love we gave
them."*

That doesn't mean we failed to save them.

Sometimes love was never meant to rescue.

*Only to remind someone they were never alone while they
searched for their own way."*

LETTER SEVENTEEN

The Empty Chair

*"Some absences are so quiet that we only notice them when we stop expecting
someone to return."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER SEVENTEEN

The Empty Chair

*"Some absences are so quiet that we only notice them when we stop
expecting someone to return."*

Dear You,

There's a chair in my memory.

It doesn't belong to anyone anymore.

Yet somehow...

It's always occupied.

...

Sometimes I imagine someone sitting there.

Laughing.

Talking.

Asking how my day was.

Other times...

It's simply empty.

And somehow...

That hurts more.

...

It's strange how an empty chair can carry so much weight.

It reminds us of dinners that became quieter.

Conversations that ended too soon.

Promises that were never meant to become memories.

...

People think we miss voices.

I don't think we do.

I think we miss habits.

The way someone always arrived five minutes late.

The way they reached for the last piece of food without asking.

The way they filled a room without trying.

Love is rarely remembered through grand moments.

It's remembered through ordinary ones.

...

Sometimes I walk past places that haven't changed.

The same walls.

The same windows.

The same table.

Only one thing is different.

Someone is missing.

And suddenly...

The entire room feels unfamiliar.

...

Absence has a peculiar way of changing the shape of a place.

A house remains standing.

Yet it no longer feels like home.

A photograph remains untouched.

Yet everyone in it has grown older.

A favourite café still serves the same coffee.

Yet the seat across from us stays empty.

Life continues.

But not in the same direction.

...

There are goodbyes we understand.

There are others...

We continue speaking to long after the conversation has ended.

I still catch myself thinking,

"I should tell them about this."

Then...

Reality quietly clears its throat.

And I remember.

...

No one talks about those moments.

The tiny heartbreaks.

Reaching for your phone before remembering there's no one to call.

Saving a story you'll never get to tell.

Turning toward a voice that no longer lives in the room.

Grief rarely arrives as a wave.

Sometimes...

It arrives as a habit.

...

I used to believe healing meant letting go.

Now...

I wonder if healing is learning to carry someone differently.

Not on our shoulders.

Not as a weight.

But as a quiet part of who we've become.

Maybe that's why certain songs still matter.

Why certain dates still feel different.

Why certain chairs remain impossible to replace.

...

If there's an empty chair somewhere in your life...

I hope you don't rush to fill it.

Not every space was meant to be replaced.

Some are meant to remind us...

That love leaves shape behind.

...

One day...

You may walk past that chair...

And instead of feeling your heart sink...

You might smile.

Not because you've forgotten.

Because you've finally learned that remembering doesn't always
have to hurt.

Maybe that's what peace looks like.

Not the absence of grief.

But the ability to sit beside it...

Without feeling alone.

Until the next letter.

—

"The people we lose don't always leave our lives.

Sometimes

they simply stop needing a chair."

LETTER EIGHTEEN

To the Days I Didn't Feel Anything

"The absence of pain isn't always peace. Sometimes, it's simply the absence of feeling."

By Sky하늘

LETTER EIGHTEEN

To the Days I Didn't Feel Anything

*"The absence of pain isn't always peace. Sometimes, it's simply the
absence of feeling."*

Dear You,

I used to think the worst thing that could happen...

Was feeling too much.

Too much sadness.

Too much fear.

Too much loneliness.

I was wrong.

...

The hardest days weren't the ones when I cried.

They were the days...

I couldn't.

...

Nothing was wrong.

Nothing was right.

The world simply...

Continued.

...

People smiled.

I smiled back.

Someone told a joke.

I laughed because I knew that was the moment people usually
laughed.

Not because I found it funny.

...

I remember listening to a song that once meant everything to me.

I waited for the memories.

For the ache.

For the warmth.

For something.

Anything.

There was only silence.

Not around me.

Inside me.

...

I began measuring time differently.

Not by months.

Or seasons.

But by moments that almost made me feel alive.

A sunset that lasted a few seconds.

The smell of coffee in the morning.

Rain against the window.

A child laughing in a supermarket.

Tiny things.

They didn't stay.

But they reminded me...

That somewhere beneath all the numbness...

My heart was still trying.

...

People often ask,

"What's wrong?"

I never knew how to answer.

Because "nothing" felt more truthful than trying to explain everything.

How do you describe the absence of emotion...

To someone expecting a reason?

...

It's strange.

When you're sad...

People notice.

When you're angry...

People step back.

But when you're numb...

You become invisible.

Because from the outside...

You still look like yourself.

...

I went to work.

Answered messages.

Paid bills.

Remembered birthdays.

I became incredibly good...

At existing.

Living...

Was another story.

...

I started questioning myself.

"Maybe I'm just lazy."

"Maybe I'm ungrateful."

"Maybe everyone feels like this."

The mind has a cruel way of turning exhaustion...

Into guilt.

...

One afternoon...

I realized I couldn't remember the last thing I genuinely looked forward to.

That frightened me.

Not because I had lost hope.

Because I had stopped noticing its absence.

...

No one tells you...

That healing sometimes begins long before happiness returns.

Sometimes...

Healing is simply brushing your teeth.

Opening the curtains.

Answering one message.

Watering a plant.

Making your bed.

Not because those things fix your heart.

Because they quietly remind it...

That tomorrow still exists.

...

If these words feel familiar...

Please don't mistake your numbness for failure.

Sometimes...

Feeling nothing...

Is how the mind survives feeling too much for too long.

You are not broken.

You are tired in ways that don't always have names.

And tired things...

Deserve rest.

Not judgment.

...

I don't know when the colours return.

I wish I did.

But I know this.

The fact that you're still here...

Still turning pages...

Still searching for words that understand you...

Means there is a part of you...

No matter how quiet...

That still believes feeling is possible.

Hold on to that part.

Even if today...

It whispers.

Until the next letter.

—

"One day

the song will sound like music again.

You don't have to force yourself to hear it.

Just don't throw away the playlist."

LETTER NINETEEN

To the Apology I Never Received

*"Some wounds don't stay open because they were too deep. They stay open
because no one ever admitted they were there."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER NINETEEN

To the Apology I Never Received

"Some wounds don't stay open because they were too deep. They stay open because no one ever admitted they were there."

Dear You,

For a long time...

I thought I was waiting for an apology.

I imagined it often.

A phone call.

A message.

A knock at the door.

Someone saying,

"I was wrong."

"I'm sorry."

"You didn't deserve that."

Just a few words.

I thought those words would change everything.

...

Years passed.

Nothing came.

Not because they forgot.

Maybe...

Because they remembered differently.

...

Memory is a strange place.

Two people can stand in the same moment...

And spend the rest of their lives carrying completely different versions of it.

One walks away thinking,

"It wasn't a big deal."

The other...

Never fully leaves.

...

I used to rehearse conversations that would never happen.

I'd win the argument.

I'd finally explain how much it hurt.

They would understand.

They would cry.

They would apologize.

Then we'd both leave lighter than we arrived.

Reality...

Never read that script.

...

There are apologies we never receive because pride speaks louder than regret.

Others...

Because people don't realize the damage they left behind.

And some...

Because life simply moves on before either heart is ready.

None of those reasons make the silence easier.

...

The hardest part wasn't what happened.

It was wondering if it mattered.

If they ever stayed awake thinking about it.

If my name ever crossed their mind the way theirs crossed mine.

If they ever wished they had chosen different words.

...

Sometimes I convinced myself...

If they apologized...

I would finally be free.

But freedom built upon another person's decision...

Isn't freedom at all.

It's waiting.

And waiting has a way of quietly becoming a home.

...

I don't know exactly when it happened...

But one day...

I grew tired.

Not of remembering.

Of expecting.

There's a difference.

One keeps the past alive.

The other refuses to let the future begin.

...

So I stopped standing at the door.

Not because someone arrived.

Because I finally accepted they might never.

...

Acceptance isn't a celebration.

It doesn't erase the hurt.

It doesn't rewrite history.

It simply whispers,

"You don't have to keep holding your breath anymore."

...

If you're still waiting for an apology...

I hope you understand something I learned too late.

An apology has value because it acknowledges the wound.

But the absence of an apology...

Doesn't erase the wound either.

You don't need someone else's permission...

To admit that what happened hurt.

Your pain is not made real by their confession.

It was real the moment you carried it.

...

Perhaps that's why healing feels so unfair.

Sometimes...

The person who caused the wound...

Never sees the scar.

Yet the person carrying it...

Must still learn how to live with it.

...

I wish life gave us neat endings.

A final conversation.

A perfect explanation.

A goodbye that answered every question.

Instead...

It gives us unfinished sentences.

And asks us to keep writing anyway.

...

Maybe closure isn't the moment someone finally says,

"I'm sorry."

Maybe...

Closure is the moment you stop needing them to.

Until the next letter.

—

"Some apologies never arrive.

That doesn't mean your pain was imaginary.

*It only means your healing could no longer wait for
someone else's courage."*

LETTER TWENTY

To the Life I Thought I'd Have

*"One of the quietest heartbreaks is grieving a future that never had the chance
to exist."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWENTY

To the Life I Thought I'd Have

"One of the quietest heartbreaks is grieving a future that never had the chance to exist."

Dear You,

When I was younger...

I believed life would happen in order.

There would be a right time for everything.

A right age.

A right path.

A right version of me waiting at the finish line.

...

I imagined a future so clearly...

That I mistook it for a promise.

I never realized...

It was only a possibility.

...

Somewhere, in an old notebook...

There is a list.

Places I wanted to visit.

Dreams I wanted to chase.

The person I hoped to become.

Sometimes I wonder if that younger version of me...

Would recognize the life I'm living now.

...

Maybe they would smile.

Maybe they would cry.

Maybe...

They would quietly ask,

"What happened?"

...

I don't think I would know how to answer.

Because nothing happened all at once.

Life simply...

Kept happening.

One responsibility became another.

One delay became another year.

One compromise became another version of myself.

Until I woke up one morning...

Wondering when the future I imagined...

Became the past I never lived.

...

The strange thing about growing older...

Isn't watching your hair change.

Or the lines on your hands.

It's realizing you've started measuring time...

By what didn't happen.

The call that never came.

The love that never stayed.

The dream that waited too long.

The goodbye you never expected.

The version of yourself...

You quietly stopped introducing.

...

I used to think disappointment came from failing.

Now I think...

It often comes from comparing reality...

To a story that only ever lived in our minds.

...

There are days I catch myself saying,

"By now, I should have..."

I should have achieved more.

I should have figured life out.

I should have become someone else.

That sentence has stolen more peace from me...

Than any mistake ever has.

Because life has never followed the word...

"Should."

...

I look around sometimes.

Friends buying homes.

Starting families.

Changing careers.

Travelling the world.

Everyone seems to know where they're going.

Then I remember...

I've only been comparing their visible chapters...

To the private draft of my own.

No one publishes the pages where they felt lost.

No one frames the years they spent questioning themselves.

We only see the moments that look complete.

Never the nights they almost gave up.

...

Maybe the life I imagined...

Was never meant to happen exactly as I planned.

Maybe...

Its purpose wasn't to become my destination.

Maybe it existed...

To teach me how to dream.

And perhaps...

The person I've become...

Isn't a failed version of who I wanted to be.

Just...

A different story.

One I never expected to write.

...

If you're mourning the life you thought you'd have...

Please don't confuse a different path...

With a meaningless one.

The map changed.

That doesn't mean the journey ended.

Some roads disappear.

Others appear only after we've stopped searching for them.

...

Tonight...

Be kind to the person who once believed life would be simpler.

They weren't naïve.

They were hopeful.

And hope...

Should never be something we're embarrassed to have carried.

...

Maybe you'll never become the person you imagined at eighteen.

Or twenty-five.

Or thirty.

That's all right.

Those versions of you were making plans...

With the knowledge they had then.

The person reading this now...

Has survived things they never could have imagined.

Perhaps they deserve the chance...

To dream differently.

Not because the old dream failed.

Because you have changed.

And that changes everything.

Until the next letter.

—

"You are not behind.

You are not late.

*You are simply living a story that refused to follow the
outline you once wrote.*

Sometimes...

*the unwritten chapters become the ones worth
remembering."*

LETTER TWENTY- ONE

To the Person I Kept Forgiving

*"There comes a moment when forgiveness stops being kindness and quietly
becomes permission."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWENTY-ONE

To the Person I Kept Forgiving

"There comes a moment when forgiveness stops being kindness and quietly becomes permission."

Dear You,

Maybe you've loved someone...

Who only returned when they needed something.

Maybe you've answered calls...

That were never followed by,

"How have you been?"

Maybe you've kept giving...

Because you believed love was measured by how much of yourself you were willing to lose.

...

I understand.

I did too.

...

For a long time...

I confused forgiveness with hope.

Every apology became another beginning.

Every promise became another reason to stay.

I wasn't holding on because things were getting better.

I was holding on...

Because I couldn't bear the thought that this might be the end.

...

People often say,

"Everyone deserves a second chance."

I agree.

But no one talks about the tenth chance.

Or the twentieth.

Or the quiet exhaustion of rebuilding the same bridge...

For someone who keeps setting it on fire.

...

I kept telling myself,

"They've changed."

Sometimes they had.

For a week.

For a month.

Long enough for hope to unpack its bags.

Then...

The silence returned.

The disappointment returned.

The loneliness returned.

And somehow...

So did I.

...

Maybe the hardest person to be honest with...

Is yourself.

Because hope has a beautiful voice.

It whispers,

"One more time."

"Maybe this time."

"Don't give up yet."

Hope isn't always wrong.

But sometimes...

It falls in love with potential...

While reality quietly waits outside the door.

...

One day...

I stopped asking,

"Why do they keep hurting me?"

And asked something much harder.

"Why do I keep believing that pain is the price of being loved?"

That question stayed with me.

Long after they had gone.

...

Perhaps some of us learned that love meant endurance.

That if we stayed long enough...

Loved hard enough...

Forgave enough...

We would finally be chosen.

No one told us...

That healthy love doesn't ask you to audition every day.

...

Maybe you've been trying to save a relationship...

That only survives because you're the one carrying it.

Maybe you've mistaken your effort...

For mutual love.

Maybe you've been calling it loyalty...

When it's really fear of letting go.

...

Walking away isn't always anger.

Sometimes...

It's grief with enough courage to stand up.

...

I used to think leaving meant giving up.

Now...

I wonder if leaving can also mean returning.

Returning to your peace.

Returning to your dignity.

Returning to the parts of yourself...

You abandoned while trying to keep someone else from leaving.

...

If this letter feels uncomfortable...

Perhaps it's because you've spent so long protecting someone else's feelings...

That you've forgotten your own needed protection too.

You deserve relationships...

Where apologies become change.

Where effort travels in both directions.

Where love doesn't leave you questioning your worth every night.

...

Maybe forgiveness doesn't always mean another chance.

Maybe...

Sometimes...

Forgiveness simply means...

You stop carrying the anger.

Not the boundary.

The anger.

There is a difference.

And learning that difference...

May be one of the kindest things you ever do for yourself.

Until the next letter.

—

"Not everyone who leaves your life is a loss.

Sometimes..

they're the space your peace was waiting for."

LETTER TWENTY- TWO

To the Silence Between Us

*"Not every relationship ends with goodbye. Some simply become quieter until
one day, silence answers where love once did."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWENTY-TWO

To the Silence Between Us

*"Not every relationship ends with goodbye. Some simply become quieter
until one day, silence answers where love once did."*

Dear You,

Maybe the saddest conversations...

Are the ones that never happen.

Not because there were no words.

Because neither heart knew where to begin.

...

There was a time...

When silence between us felt comfortable.

We didn't have to fill every moment.

Your presence was enough.

My presence was enough.

The quiet belonged to us.

...

Somewhere along the way...

Silence changed.

It stopped feeling peaceful.

It started feeling careful.

Every sentence became something to rehearse.

Every reply became something to measure.

Every pause...

Began asking questions neither of us wanted to answer.

...

I still wonder...

When was the last normal conversation?

The last laugh that wasn't trying to hide something.

The last,

"How was your day?"

That truly wanted to know.

Memory doesn't tell me.

It only remembers...

That one day we stopped speaking the same language.

Not because we used different words.

Because we carried different wounds.

...

Maybe you've experienced this too.

Sitting across from someone you still love...

Feeling farther away than strangers.

Watching them smile...

While wondering if they feel the same distance.

Wanting to ask,

"Are we okay?"

But fearing the answer more than the silence.

...

People think relationships break because of one terrible moment.

Sometimes...

They disappear through ordinary days.

The message you forgot to send.

The apology you delayed.

The feeling you decided could wait until tomorrow.

Tomorrow...

Has a habit of becoming years.

...

There are silences that heal.

The silence after forgiveness.

The silence of watching the rain together.

The silence of knowing you don't have to explain yourself.

But there are other silences.

The kind that grows between two people like an empty hallway.

Neither person walks across it.

Both hope the other will.

And eventually...

The hallway becomes a lifetime.

...

Maybe neither of us meant for this to happen.

Maybe we were both tired.

Maybe we were both hurting.

Maybe we were both waiting...

For the other person to speak first.

It's heartbreaking...

How often love loses to hesitation.

...

There are still things I wish I could tell you.

Not to change the past.

Not to make you stay.

Just...

To let those words breathe somewhere outside my chest.

To tell you that despite everything...

Some part of me never stopped wishing you well.

Even when we stopped knowing each other.

...

If you're carrying a silence like this...

Please don't spend your life searching for who was more at fault.

Some distances aren't built by one person.

They're built by moments.

Small ones.

Forgotten ones.

Until they become impossible to cross.

...

And if one day...

Life gives you another chance to tell someone,

"I appreciate you."

"I miss you."

"I forgive you."

"I was wrong."

Don't wait for the perfect time.

Silence has stolen enough from us already.

...

Maybe not every broken connection can be repaired.

But perhaps...

The next one doesn't have to break in the same way.

Maybe that's how we honour the people we lost.

Not by living in regret.

But by speaking while love is still listening.

Until the next letter.

—

"Some relationships don't end because love disappears.

*They end because silence slowly becomes easier than
honesty.*

Choose honesty while there's still someone there to hear it."

LETTER TWENTY- THREE

To the Scars I Tried to Erase

*"The things we try hardest to hide often become the very things that shape
us."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWENTY-THREE

To the Scars I Tried to Erase

*"The things we try hardest to hide often become the very things that
shape us."*

Dear You,

Maybe you've looked back at your life...

And found a version of yourself you wish had never existed.

The one who trusted the wrong people.

The one who stayed too long.

The one who walked away too soon.

The one who made choices you still don't understand.

...

I have.

...

For years...

I treated my past like a crime scene.

I kept returning to it.

Looking for evidence.

Searching for the exact moment everything went wrong.

As though finding it...

Would somehow change what happened.

It never did.

...

Regret has a peculiar way of introducing itself.

It doesn't shout.

It whispers.

Late at night.

In the middle of ordinary days.

During moments that should have been peaceful.

It asks questions that have no answers.

"What if?"

"Why didn't I?"

"If only..."

Three of the heaviest sentences a heart can carry.

...

I used to believe healing meant forgetting.

Forgetting the people.

Forgetting the mistakes.

Forgetting the version of me that made them.

But memories don't disappear because we ask them to.

They simply become quieter.

Waiting for a familiar song.

A familiar place.

A familiar date.

To remind us they never truly left.

...

There were parts of my story...

I wanted to cut out completely.

Conversations that still make me cringe.

Decisions that still make me lower my head.

Moments I wished no one remembered.

Especially me.

...

But one day...

A thought interrupted me.

What if I'm asking the wrong question?

Instead of asking,

"How do I erase this?"

Maybe I should ask,

"What did this leave behind?"

Not the damage.

The lesson.

Not the embarrassment.

The growth.

Not the scar.

The healing that came after it.

...

Scars are strange.

When they're fresh...

They convince us they'll always hurt.

Then time passes.

The pain changes.

The wound closes.

Yet something remains.

Not to remind us of our weakness.

But to remind us...

That we survived something capable of changing us.

...

Maybe that's why we struggle to accept our past.

Because we think acceptance means approval.

It doesn't.

You can wish something had never happened...

And still accept that it did.

You can grieve the person you used to be...

Without spending the rest of your life punishing them.

...

I've realized something.

The person I judge most harshly...

Is often the person who had the least experience.

The least wisdom.

The least understanding.

The younger version of me wasn't trying to ruin my life.

They were simply trying to survive it...

With the knowledge they had at the time.

Perhaps they deserved compassion...

Not a lifetime sentence.

...

If there's a memory you've been hiding from...

Maybe stop running for a moment.

Sit beside it.

Listen.

Not because it deserves to hurt you again.

Because perhaps...

It has been waiting all these years...

To stop being your enemy.

...

One day...

You'll tell your story.

Not with pride.

Not with shame.

Just honesty.

And you'll realize...

The chapters you tried hardest to erase...

Were the ones that taught you how to become gentle.

Not only with others.

But finally...

With yourself.

Until the next letter.

"Your scars are not asking to be admired.

*They're asking to stop being treated like evidence against
you.*

You have carried the punishment long enough."

LETTER TWENTY- FOUR

To the Weight I Was Never Meant to Carry

*"Some burdens don't become lighter with time. They become familiar, and we
mistake familiarity for responsibility."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWENTY-FOUR

To the Weight I Was Never Meant to Carry

*"Some burdens don't become lighter with time. They become familiar,
and we mistake familiarity for responsibility."*

Dear You,

Maybe you've been apologizing...

For things that were never your fault.

Maybe you've spent years trying to make peace...

Between people who had already chosen conflict.

Maybe you've carried guilt...

Simply because you happened to be there.

...

It's a strange thing...

The way we inherit burdens no one ever asked us to hold.

...

Sometimes...

It begins with a sentence.

"Be the bigger person."

"Don't make things worse."

"Just let it go."

"Keep the family together."

"You're the strong one."

At first...

They sound like wisdom.

Years later...

You realize they've quietly become instructions for disappearing.

...

I became the listener.

The mediator.

The one who stayed calm.

The one who understood everyone else's reasons.

I became so good at understanding others...

That I stopped asking whether anyone understood me.

...

Maybe you've done that too.

Explained away someone else's behaviour.

Excused words that left bruises no one could see.

Accepted less than you deserved...

Because you believed love meant carrying what others refused to.

...

One day...

I noticed something.

Whenever someone was unhappy...

I immediately searched for my own mistake.

Not because I had made one.

Because my heart had learned...

That someone else's sadness must somehow belong to me.

...

That realization frightened me.

How many years had I spent cleaning up storms...

That weren't mine to begin with?

How many nights had I stayed awake...

Trying to solve problems...

That no amount of worrying could ever solve?

...

There is a difference...

Between caring...

And carrying.

Caring says,

"I'm here with you."

Carrying says,

"I'll suffer in your place."

One is compassion.

The other...

Is exhaustion wearing compassion's face.

...

I wish someone had told me earlier...

That love has boundaries.

Not because love is small.

Because people are.

Our hearts were never designed...

To become homes for every sorrow we encounter.

We can offer shelter.

We cannot become the shelter.

...

Maybe you've been trying to heal someone...

Who isn't ready.

Maybe you've been waiting for someone to become the person
you know they could be.

Maybe you've spent years believing...

That if you just loved a little harder...

Everything would finally make sense.

I understand.

Hope can become very heavy...

When we refuse to put it down.

...

Please hear this...

Even if it feels difficult.

You are not responsible...

For another person's willingness to change.

You are not responsible...

For every disappointment they carry.

You are not responsible...

For saving relationships that only survive because you're the only one trying.

Some burdens...

Remain heavy...

Because they were never yours.

...

Perhaps that's what boundaries really are.

Not walls.

Not punishments.

Just quiet reminders...

Of where your heart ends...

And someone else's begins.

...

Maybe tonight...

Before you close your eyes...

Imagine placing every burden in front of you.

One by one.

Ask yourself a simple question.

"Did someone hand this to me...

or did I quietly pick it up because I thought love required it?"

You may be surprised...

By how much you've been carrying with empty hands.

...

If so...

You don't have to throw it away.

You don't have to become cold.

You don't have to stop loving.

Just...

Put it down.

For a while.

Your hands deserve to remember...

What it feels like...

To be empty.

Until the next letter.

—

"You can love someone deeply...

without carrying the life they refuse to carry themselves.

Compassion does not ask you to disappear."

LETTER TWENTY- FIVE

To the Fear of Starting Again

"Sometimes the hardest part isn't letting go of the past. It's believing the future won't ask you to relive it."

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWENTY-FIVE

To the Fear of Starting Again

"Sometimes the hardest part isn't letting go of the past. It's believing the future won't ask you to relive it."

Dear You,

Maybe you've been standing...

At the edge of a new beginning.

Not because you don't know where to go.

Because you remember where the last road ended.

...

People often say,

"Just move on."

As if moving forward were a decision.

As if fear could be packed into a box...

And left beside yesterday.

If only hearts were that simple.

...

Maybe you've convinced yourself...

That you're being careful.

But if you're honest...

Perhaps you've simply become afraid.

Afraid to trust again.

Afraid to hope again.

Afraid to build something...

That life might ask you to lose.

...

I understand.

Once you've watched something beautiful fall apart...

Even happiness begins to feel temporary.

You start reading every joyful moment...

Like it comes with an expiration date.

You smile.

But a part of you quietly asks,

"How long will this last?"

...

Fear has an unusual kindness.

It tells us,

"Don't try.

You can't lose what you never begin."

For a while...

That sounds like wisdom.

Then one day...

You realize it has quietly become another way of staying still.

...

I spent years believing I was protecting my heart.

Looking back...

I think I was protecting my fear.

There is a difference.

One keeps you safe.

The other keeps you small.

...

Starting again doesn't erase what happened.

It doesn't ask you to forget.

It simply asks one question.

"Will you let yesterday decide who gets to meet you tomorrow?"

...

Maybe you've become someone who double-checks every
goodbye.

Who hesitates before saying,

"I love you."

Who waits for disappointment...

Before allowing yourself to enjoy the moment.

Not because you're negative.

Because you've learned...

That losing hurts.

...

But there's something else I've learned.

Never beginning...

Has its own kind of grief.

It's quieter.

No one sees it.

There are no dramatic endings.

Only years spent wondering,

"What if I had tried?"

Sometimes...

That question weighs more than failure ever could.

...

If you're waiting until you're fearless...

You may be waiting forever.

Courage has never been the absence of fear.

Perhaps...

It's the decision to let fear ride beside you...

Instead of asking it to hold the steering wheel.

...

Maybe your next beginning won't look impressive.

Maybe it's sending the message you've been rewriting.

Applying for the job you don't think you'll get.

Opening the notebook that's been gathering dust.

Laughing again without feeling guilty.

Trusting someone with a small part of your heart.

Tiny beginnings.

They rarely look important.

Until years later...

When you realize they changed everything.

...

So if life is quietly inviting you to begin again...

You don't have to run.

You don't have to know every answer.

You don't even have to feel ready.

Just...

Take one honest step.

Then another.

Not because the road promises safety.

Because you've already survived roads that never did.

...

And maybe...

One day...

You'll look back at this version of yourself.

The one standing still.

The one filled with doubt.

The one wondering if it's worth trying again.

You'll smile gently.

Not because they were weak.

Because they stepped forward...

While their hands were still shaking.

Until the next letter.

—

"New beginnings are rarely loud.

Most of them begin with one quiet sentence.

'Maybe.. I'll try again tomorrow.'"

LETTER TWENTY- SIX

To the Version of Me That Stayed

*"Perhaps the bravest thing you ever did was continue becoming a person the
world never saw struggling."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWENTY-SIX

To the Version of Me That Stayed

*"Perhaps the bravest thing you ever did was continue becoming a person
the world never saw struggling."*

Dear You,

Maybe no one knows...

How many times you almost gave up.

Not on life.

On believing that things could ever feel different.

...

Maybe no one knows...

How many mornings you got out of bed...

Not because you wanted to.

Because there were people depending on you.

Or because the sun came up...

And somehow...

So did you.

...

There are victories...

The world never celebrates.

Getting through a difficult week.

Answering a message when silence felt easier.

Walking into work while your heart was somewhere else.

Making dinner.

Taking a shower.

Smiling at a stranger.

Breathing through another anxious afternoon.

No trophies.

No applause.

No photographs.

Just...

Quiet acts of survival.

...

For so long...

You judged yourself by everything you hadn't done.

The dreams you postponed.

The opportunities you missed.

The promises you couldn't keep.

You rarely stopped...

To notice everything you did.

You kept loving...

Even after disappointment.

You kept hoping...

Even after heartbreak.

You kept showing kindness...

Even when your own heart felt empty.

You kept trying.

Some days...

That was enough.

...

Maybe you don't feel strong.

That's understandable.

Strength often looks different from the inside.

From the inside...

It feels like exhaustion.

It feels like doubt.

It feels like wondering whether you'll ever stop carrying so much.

From the outside...

People simply call you resilient.

They never see the conversation you had with yourself...

Just to make it through another ordinary day.

...

There were nights...

You believed no one would understand.

Days...

You questioned your own worth.

Moments...

You wondered if the person you used to be...

Was gone forever.

Yet somehow...

You remained.

Not unchanged.

Not untouched.

Not unbroken.

You remained.

...

I've come to believe...

There is something beautiful...

About people who stay soft...

After life gives them every reason to become hard.

Not because softness is easy.

Because it costs something.

It costs forgiveness.

Patience.

Hope.

The willingness to believe...

That tomorrow deserves another chance.

...

Maybe you've spent years waiting...

To become someone you're finally proud of.

What if...

The person deserving of your respect...

Isn't waiting somewhere in the future?

What if...

They're the one reading this letter right now?

The one who survived days...

They never imagined surviving.

The one who carried grief without letting it erase kindness.

The one who made mistakes...

And kept growing anyway.

The one who is still here.

...

You don't have to admire every chapter of your life.

Some chapters were written in fear.

Some in loneliness.

Some in confusion.

But every chapter...

Brought this version of you here.

The one who finally understands...

That surviving is not something to be embarrassed by.

...

If no one has ever thanked you...

Allow this letter to.

Thank you...

For not giving up on yourself...

Even when you didn't know...

Who you were becoming.

Thank you...

For carrying hope...

Even when it fit inside your heart...

No larger than a whisper.

Thank you...

For staying.

Not because staying was easy.

Because leaving would've been easier.

...

And if tomorrow feels heavy again...

You don't have to remember every lesson you've learned.

Just remember one.

You've already survived days...

You once believed would break you.

You don't need proof that you're capable.

You are the proof.

Until the next letter.

—

*"The strongest part of you was never the part that never
broke.*

*It was the part that quietly gathered every broken piece
and chose to remain."*

LETTER TWENTY- SEVEN

To the Hope I Thought I'd Lost

*"Hope doesn't always return with fireworks. Sometimes it returns as
curiosity."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWENTY-SEVEN

To the Hope I Thought I'd Lost

"Hope doesn't always return with fireworks. Sometimes it returns as curiosity."

Dear You,

Maybe you've been waiting...

To feel like yourself again.

As though one morning...

You'll wake up...

And everything will finally make sense.

...

I used to wait for that morning too.

I imagined healing would arrive all at once.

Like sunlight breaking through heavy clouds.

Like a door opening.

Like finally reaching the end of a very long road.

...

It never happened that way.

...

Instead...

It arrived quietly.

So quietly...

I almost missed it.

...

One morning...

I caught myself laughing.

Not loudly.

Not for very long.

Just...

Long enough to forget I had been hurting.

For a few seconds...

I wasn't surviving.

I was simply living.

...

Another day...

I bought food I had been craving.

Not because I was hungry.

Because it sounded nice.

That surprised me.

I hadn't realized...

How long it had been...

Since I wanted anything.

...

Healing didn't introduce itself.

It disguised itself...

As ordinary moments.

Opening the window.

Calling an old friend.

Taking the longer road home...

Simply because the evening looked beautiful.

...

Hope isn't always a feeling.

Sometimes...

It's a decision so small...

You don't recognize it until much later.

It's washing your favourite mug...

Instead of whichever one is closest.

It's making plans...

Even if they're only for next weekend.

It's planting something...

Knowing you'll have to be here to watch it grow.

...

There was a time...

When tomorrow frightened me.

Now...

Sometimes...

Tomorrow makes me curious.

Not excited.

Not fearless.

Just...

Curious.

And perhaps...

That's enough.

...

Maybe we put too much pressure on hope.

We expect it to arrive...

Confident.

Bright.

Certain.

But real hope...

Often walks with a limp.

It still remembers disappointment.

It still glances over its shoulder.

It still carries old scars.

The difference is...

It keeps walking anyway.

...

If today still feels heavy...

Don't force yourself to search for joy.

Instead...

Look for one small reason...

To wonder what tomorrow might hold.

Not because tomorrow owes you happiness.

Because life has surprised you before.

It may yet surprise you again.

...

You don't need to believe...

That everything will work out.

You don't need to convince yourself...

That the hardest days are over.

Just leave the door unlocked.

Hope has a gentle habit...

Of letting itself in...

When we stop demanding that it arrive all at once.

...

Maybe...

The person you become...

Will not be happier every day.

But perhaps...

They'll notice more sunsets.

Call their mother a little more often.

Tell their friends they matter.

Laugh without apologising for it.

Rest when they're tired.

Cry when they need to.

Stay when life asks them to.

If that's who you're becoming...

Then hope never really left.

It was simply waiting...

For you to slow down enough...

To recognize its footsteps.

Until the next letter.

—

"Hope rarely returns as certainty.

More often...

it arrives as a quiet thought.

'I wonder what tomorrow looks like.'

Sometimes...

that's all a heart needs to keep going."

LETTER TWENTY- EIGHT

To the Home I Found Within Myself

*"For years, I searched for a place that would finally make me feel safe. I
never imagined I was slowly becoming that place."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWENTY-EIGHT

To the Home I Found Within Myself

*"For years, I searched for a place that would finally make me feel safe.
I never imagined I was slowly becoming that place."*

Dear You,

Maybe you've spent your whole life...

Looking for somewhere to belong.

A room where no one asked you to explain yourself.

A voice that felt familiar.

A pair of hands that never made you question your worth.

A place that whispered,

"You can rest now."

...

Perhaps that's what we've all been searching for.

Not perfection.

Not certainty.

Just...

Somewhere our hearts can finally put their bags down.

...

For a long time...

I thought home was a destination.

A house.

A relationship.

A future I hadn't reached yet.

I kept believing...

"When I finally arrive...

I'll finally feel whole."

So I kept chasing.

New places.

New people.

New beginnings.

Always convinced...

That peace lived somewhere ahead of me.

...

But peace has an unusual habit.

The harder you chase it...

The farther it seems to walk away.

...

One evening...

Nothing extraordinary happened.

I made myself a cup of tea.

Sat near the window.

Watched the sky fade from gold into blue.

The room was quiet.

No messages.

No plans.

No one waiting for me.

Years ago...

That silence would have frightened me.

That evening...

It didn't.

For the first time...

Being alone...

Didn't feel like being abandoned.

It felt like being accompanied...

By someone I had spent years trying to avoid.

Myself.

...

I smiled.

Not because everything in my life was perfect.

Because for a few gentle moments...

I wasn't trying to become someone else.

I wasn't apologising for who I was.

I wasn't comparing my life to anyone else's.

I simply existed.

And strangely...

That was enough.

...

Maybe home isn't a place we find.

Maybe...

It's a relationship we slowly build.

With our own thoughts.

Our own mistakes.

Our own silence.

The kind of relationship that doesn't disappear...

When other people leave.

...

I still have difficult days.

There are mornings...

When old fears knock on the door.

There are nights...

When loneliness quietly sits beside me.

The difference is...

I no longer ask those feelings to leave immediately.

I pour them a cup of tea.

I let them stay for a while.

Then I watch them leave...

The same way the rain eventually stops.

Without needing to argue with the sky.

...

Maybe that's what growing older has been teaching me all along.

Not how to avoid pain.

How to stop running from it.

To stop treating every difficult emotion...

Like an unwanted guest.

To understand that even sadness...

Is only asking to be heard...

Before it continues on its way.

...

If you're still searching...

Please don't be discouraged.

Some journeys take us around the world...

Only to bring us gently back...

To ourselves.

Not because we were lost.

Because we had never properly introduced ourselves.

...

One day...

You'll notice something small.

You'll make yourself your favourite meal.

You'll laugh at a joke no one else heard.

You'll sit in comfortable silence.

You'll forgive yourself for something you once thought unforgivable.

And without announcing itself...

Home will arrive.

Not with a key.

Not with an address.

But with a feeling.

The quiet certainty...

That wherever life takes you next...

You no longer have to abandon yourself to belong.

Until the next letter.

—

*"Perhaps home was never the place you were trying to
reach.*

Perhaps...

*it was the version of yourself that finally stopped asking for
permission to exist.*

And maybe...

that's the safest place you'll ever know."

LETTER TWENTY- NINE

Tomorrow

*"The future has always been uncertain. The difference is it no longer feels like
an enemy."*

By Sky하늘

LETTER TWENTY-NINE

Tomorrow

*"The future has always been uncertain. The difference is it no longer
feels like an enemy."*

Dear You,

Tomorrow...

What a strange word.

We've spent so much of our lives...

Waiting for it.

Fearing it.

Blaming it.

Depending on it.

As though everything we've ever wanted...

Lived one day beyond our reach.

...

When I was younger...

Tomorrow was where all my dreams lived.

Then...

For a while...

Tomorrow became where all my fears waited.

Every sunrise...

Felt like another question I didn't know how to answer.

Another chance to fall behind.

Another reminder...

Of everything I hadn't figured out yet.

...

But somewhere along this journey...

Tomorrow changed.

Not because life became easier.

Because I stopped asking it...

To become perfect.

...

There is a quiet freedom...

In no longer needing every chapter...

To become your favourite one.

Some days will still disappoint you.

Some mornings will begin with heavy hearts.

Some evenings will end with unanswered questions.

That doesn't make the story broken.

It simply makes it alive.

...

I've learned...

That peace doesn't arrive...

When life finally becomes predictable.

Peace arrives...

When we stop believing uncertainty is proof that something is wrong.

...

The truth is...

None of us have ever known what tomorrow would bring.

We only imagined we did.

Maybe certainty was never the goal.

Maybe...

Trust was.

Not trust that life would always be kind.

Trust that whatever comes...

You will meet it...

One breath at a time.

...

There are still dreams I haven't reached.

People I still miss.

Questions that remain unanswered.

Some wounds still ache...

When certain memories visit.

I don't think those things will disappear completely.

And perhaps...

They don't have to.

I've stopped measuring healing...

By the absence of pain.

Now...

I measure it...

By how gently I hold it.

...

If tomorrow brings joy...

I hope you let yourself smile without wondering how long it will last.

If tomorrow brings disappointment...

I hope you remember that difficult days...

Have visited before.

And every single time...

You've found your way to another morning.

Not perfectly.

Just faithfully.

...

Maybe that's enough.

Maybe a meaningful life...

Was never about avoiding sorrow.

Maybe it was always about collecting ordinary moments...

That quietly reminded us...

We were alive.

A warm drink on a cold morning.

The sound of rain against the window.

A familiar laugh.

A message from an old friend.

The first breeze after a long, hot day.

A sky painted in colours...

No photograph could ever fully keep.

Life has always spoken softly.

We were simply too busy surviving...

To hear it.

...

So tonight...

When you finish this letter...

Don't rush toward tomorrow.

Don't fear it either.

Just...

Meet this moment.

The chair beneath you.

The air in your lungs.

The beating of your heart.

For so many years...

You searched for proof that life was still worth living.

Perhaps...

It has been quietly surrounding you all along.

...

Tomorrow will come.

As it always has.

With things you cannot predict.
With people you cannot keep forever.
With joys you never expected.
With losses you never deserved.
It will arrive...
Neither as a promise...
Nor as a punishment.
Only as another page.
And maybe...
For the first time...
You're no longer afraid to turn it.
Until the last letter.

"You don't have to know what tomorrow holds.

You only have to believe...

that whoever meets it...

will not be facing it alone.

*Because after everything you've survived...
you have finally learned how to stay beside yourself."*

LETTER THIRTY

To You

"If you've made it this far perhaps this letter was always yours."

By Sky하늘

LETTER THIRTY

To You

"If you've made it this far perhaps this letter was always yours."

Dear You,

We've spent a long time together.

Longer than either of us expected.

Somewhere between these pages...

You remembered people you thought you'd forgotten.

You revisited conversations that still echoed inside you.

You sat beside old versions of yourself...

Not to judge them.

But simply to see them again.

...

Perhaps...

That was enough.

...

When this journey began...

I thought I was writing letters.

Now I think...

I was simply trying to keep someone company.

Maybe that someone was you.

Maybe...

It was the version of me who once needed these words...

But didn't know how to write them yet.

...

If you cried...

Thank you for trusting these pages.

If you smiled...

I hope you noticed.

Because once upon a time...

You may have believed you'd forgotten how.

If nothing happened at all...

That's all right too.

Not every heart opens...

The moment someone knocks.

Some doors...

Need a little more time.

...

There will still be difficult days.

People will still leave.

Plans will still change.

Some questions...

Will remain unanswered.

I wish I could promise otherwise.

But promises like that...

Would only make this goodbye dishonest.

...

Instead...

I'd rather remind you of something you've already proven.

You have survived uncertainty.

You have survived disappointment.

You have survived days...

That quietly convinced you they would last forever.

Yet here you are.

Still reading.

Still breathing.

Still allowing tomorrow...

To arrive.

...

Maybe that's what hope has always looked like.

Not certainty.

Presence.

Choosing to remain...

Even when the path disappears into fog.

Trusting that the next step...

Doesn't need to reveal the whole journey.

Only enough ground...

For one more step.

...

I hope...

The next time you make a mistake...

You speak to yourself more gently.

I hope...

The next time someone loves you...

You don't immediately search for the reason they'll leave.

I hope...

The next time life surprises you with joy...

You don't rush to wonder when it will end.

Stay there for a while.

Let happiness finish its sentence.

...

And when sadness visits again...

Because it will...

I hope you remember...

You don't have to fight every storm.

Some rain...

Is only passing through.

...

If one day...

This book finds its way back into your hands...

Years from now...

I wonder which letter you'll stop at first.

Perhaps it won't be the one you needed today.

Perhaps you'll meet a different version of yourself...

Waiting between these pages.

If that happens...

I hope you greet them kindly.

They've been carrying you all this time.

...

Before we part...

There's one last thing I'd like to ask of you.

Not a promise.

Just a possibility.

When someone you care about quietly says,

"I'm fine."

Pause for a moment.

Stay a little longer.

Listen a little deeper.

Sometimes...

The kindest thing we can give another person...

Is the feeling that they don't have to carry their silence alone.

And if that person...

Ever happens to be you...

I hope you'll offer yourself...

That same kindness.

...

Thank you...

For walking beside these letters.

For bringing your own memories...

Your own grief...

Your own hopes...

Into words that were never completely mine.

Perhaps that's the secret these pages have been keeping.

They were never finished...

Until you read them.

...

So this isn't goodbye.

Books don't know how to say goodbye.

They simply wait...

Patiently...

On quiet shelves...

Until someone needs them again.

Until then...

Take care of the heart that carried you here.

It has survived more than it ever tells people.

It deserves your gentleness now.

More than ever.

Until we meet again.

—

"Some letters are never sent...

because they were never written for one person.

*They were written for every heart that ever believed it was
carrying the weight of the world alone.*

If one of those hearts was yours...

Thank you for letting these words walk beside you.

The rest of the story...

belongs to you."

If these pages reminded you of someone...

I hope you tell them.

If these pages reminded you of yourself...

I hope you're a little kinder to that person tomorrow than you were yesterday.

You don't have to have every answer.

You don't have to heal all at once.

You don't have to become someone else before believing you deserve peace.

If these letters have given you anything...

I hope it's permission.

Permission to feel.

Permission to rest.

Permission to begin again.

And above all...

Permission to stay.

Thank you...

For letting these words walk beside you.

If there is still a letter inside your heart

Write it.

Whether anyone reads it or not.

Take gentle care of your heart.

— *End* —